

Law group, Wageningen University & Research

Pesticide Litigation Tracker

Core document

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1. Project brief

This document provides an overview of the purpose, data sources, and functional requirements of the pesticide litigation tracker (PLT) project, initiated by Wageningen University & Research's Law chair group. This overview serves as a comprehensive blueprint for stakeholders involved in the project, guiding front- and back-end development, as well as server and infrastructure development later. This document will be updated throughout this project and across its operational phases to remain up to date.

1.1 Project goal and target audience

The goal of the PLT is to provide an open-access, automatically updated database of pesticide-related case law within the jurisdictions of the EU and its member states. The [Sabina Center's Climate Litigation Tracker](#) serves as an example. Within our project's scope, we define pesticide-related cases as public, private, and criminal law cases that center on the effects, governance, and/or liability of pesticide admission, trade, and/or use.

The PLT is intended for use by scholars and researchers, legal professionals, NGOs, civil servants, and others working on or interested in legal developments related to pesticide governance within the European Union and its member states. While potentially applicable for commercial use, the PLT will be made available on an open-access basis to enhance its use in academic research and by NGOs.

1.2 Service provision

The PLT will provide an overview of all available, online-published pesticide-related case law. In doing so, the PLT will be designed to automatically scrape cases from online platforms such as EUR-Lex (EU) and rechtspraak.nl (NL), based on the criteria described in 1.1. An overview of the data sources from which these cases will be scraped is included in Annex 2.

2. Functional requirements

This project aims to incorporate the features and data (including classification) described in this section. It also outlines the different user roles involved in the PLT.

2.1 Initial features

1. User-friendly interface primarily designed to support comfortable reading of available case law.
2. Cross-language, multilingual-based search engine: the PLT will provide English and original language searching to allow users to find relevant cases published in languages other than English, with these cases made available in their original language.

3. Full-text document search: the PLT will be equipped to enable users to search all available court documents from selected data sources.
4. Advanced filtering: the search engine will be equipped with search filters based on the classification as presented in 2.2.
5. Downloadable data: users of the PLT will be allowed to select and download all available case law, including metadata.
6. Manual addition of case law by administrators.

2.2 Data and classification

Selected case law will be published in original language, full text. Each case will be classified and presented with a case abstract and a link to its original publication webpage. The classification labels that will be adopted are as follows.

1. Jurisdiction
2. Law domain (public, private & criminal)
3. Law subfield (e.g., public; administrative)
4. Litigating parties
5. Date filing, and verdict
6. Topic (*precise classification to be further developed during project*)

2.3 User roles

Upon deployment, the PLT will be operated by three different users as detailed below; the fourth role is that of PLT users.

1. System admin: manages website configuration, integration management, security, and maintenance. Once the PLT is up and running, a third-party contractor will take up this role.
2. Communication coordinator: forms the bridge between system admin, content management, and users. This role is fulfilled by a member of the Law chair group.
3. Content manager: actively keeps track of added case law to verify eligibility according to set criteria and guarantee metadata is processed correctly. This role is fulfilled by a member of the Law chair group.
4. User: end-users of the PLT.

2.4 Potential future features

1. API access with filtering options and bulk download feature.
2. User registration and the possibility to add annotations to listed case law.
3. Litigation from jurisdictions outside of the EU.
4. Emailing list with alerts on new cases.
5. FAQ.
6. Visualisation of data insights.

3. Design and layout

3.1 Wireframes

To be discussed: low-fidelity sketches of page layouts to support visual design in content placement and user flow.

3.2 Design brief

LAW group styling.

Sabin center of climate litigation

4. Tech stack

4.1 Frontend

The frontend will be written using the React.js framework and tailwind.css for styling.

4.2 Backend

The backend will be written in Python, using Flask for creating back-end features.

4.3 Database

The data will be stored in an SQL relational database.

5. Funding options

1. EWUU: <https://preventivehealth.ewuu.nl/2026/06/seed-call-for-preventive-health-transitions-building-the-future-of-preventive-health/>

Annex 1: project timeline

Period	Phase	Activities and outcomes
June – September, 2026	Project start-up	1. Composition of a core document with detailed descriptions of the project and deliverables 2. Development of a first iteration of the database and data-pipeline, with basic functionalities for EU pesticide litigation 3. First visual impression of website design 4. Writing first textual materials as part of the website: about us, instructions, etc.
October – November, 2026	Phase A	1. Development of database and back-end, functional for EU pesticide litigation; version 1.0 2. Development of front-end with basic functionality; version 1.0 3. Compile a draft version of the website design document for the professional partner
December, 2026	Test phase 1	1. Deliberation with stakeholders, collect feedback on user experience and design
December, 2026 – February 2027	Phase B	1. Continue back-end development of version 1.0, add functionality for Dutch pesticide litigation and provide api access to database; version 2.0 2. Continue front-end development; implement visual design and improvement of functionality; version 2.0 3. Contract a professional party for final development and hosting 4. Continue development of the website design document for the professional partner
March, 2027	Test phase 2	1. Deliberation within the project group, collect feedback on user experience
March – May, 2027	Phase C	1. Continue back-end development of version 2.0, add functionality for (available) EU member state litigation; version 3.0 2. Improvement of version 2.0 front-end development, full functionality; version 3.0 3. Prepare version 3.0 (beta version) for third-party, professional development 4. Finalize the website design document for the professional partner
June - August, 2027	Third-party development	Beta version delivery to professional development and hosting partner; testing and preparing
September, 2027	Launch	

Annex 2: project data sources

Jurisdiction	Domain	Court	URL
EU	EU	Court of Justice of the European Union (CJEU)	https://curia.europa.eu
	EU	EUR-Lex (EU case law database)	https://eur-lex.europa.eu
	EU	European e-Justice Portal	https://e-justice.europa.eu
Austria	Administrative	Verwaltungsgerichtshof (VwGH)	https://www.vwgh.gv.at
	Civil/Criminal	Oberster Gerichtshof (OGH)	https://www.ogh.gv.at
	Unified	RIS Legal Information System	https://ris.bka.gv.at
Belgium	Administrative	Raad van State / Conseil d'État	https://www.raadvst-consetat.be
	Civil/Criminal	Court of Cassation	https://justitie.belgium.be
	Unified	JUportal	https://juportal.be
Bulgaria	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court	https://www.sac.government.bg
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court of Cassation	https://www.vks.bg
	Constitutional	Constitutional Court	https://www.constcourt.bg
Croatia	Administrative	High Administrative Court	https://sudskapraksa.vsrh.hr
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://www.vsrh.hr
Cyprus	Administrative	Administrative Court	https://www.cylaw.org
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://www.supremecourt.gov.cy
Czechia	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court	https://www.nssoud.cz
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://www.nsoud.cz
	Constitutional	Constitutional Court (NALUS)	https://nalus.usoud.cz
Denmark	Unified	Danish Courts (Domstolene)	https://domstol.dk
Estonia	Unified	Supreme Court (Riigikohus)	https://www.riigikohus.ee
Finland	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court	https://kho.fi
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://korkein oikeus.fi
France	Administrative	Conseil d'État	https://www.conseil-etat.fr
	Civil/Criminal	Court of Cassation	https://www.courdecassation.fr
	Unified	Légifrance Case Law Database	https://www.legifrance.gouv.fr
Germany	Administrative	Federal Administrative Court (BVerwG)	https://www.bverwg.de
	Civil/Criminal	Federal Court of Justice (BGH)	https://www.bundesgerichtshof.de
	Constitutional	Federal Constitutional Court	https://www.bundesverfassungsgericht.de
Greece	Administrative	Council of State (Ste)	https://www.ste.gr
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Civil & Criminal Court (Areios Pagos)	https://www.areiospagos.gr
Hungary	Unified	Curia of Hungary	https://kuria-birosag.hu
	Constitutional	Constitutional Court	https://alkotmanybirosag.hu
Ireland	Unified	Courts Service of Ireland	https://www.courts.ie
Italy	Administrative	Council of State (Consiglio di Stato)	https://www.giustizia-amministrativa.it
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court of Cassation	https://www.cortedicassazione.it
Latvia	Unified	Supreme Court of Latvia	https://www.at.gov.lv
Lithuania	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court	https://www.lvat.lt
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://www.lat.lt
Luxembourg	Unified	Justice Portal Luxembourg	https://justice.public.lu
Malta	Unified	Judiciary of Malta	https://judiciary.mt
Netherlands	Administrative	Council of State (Raad van State)	https://www.raadvanstate.nl

	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court (Hoge Raad)	https://www.hogeraad.nl
Poland	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court (NSA)	https://www.nsa.gov.pl
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court	https://www.sn.pl
Portugal	Administrative	Supreme Administrative Court	https://www.stap.pt
	Civil/Criminal	Supreme Court of Justice	https://www.stj.pt
Romania	Unified	High Court of Cassation and Justice	https://www.iccj.ro
Slovakia	Unified	Supreme Court / Supreme Administrative Court	https://www.nsud.sk
Slovenia	Unified	Judicial Portal of Slovenia	https://www.sodisce.si
Spain	Unified	General Council of the Judiciary (Poder Judicial)	https://www.poderjudicial.es